

Q What's the difference between an embryo and a fetus, and what does it mean for my baby?

Your baby is called an embryo while his basic body structures and major organs form. From week 10 of your pregnancy (eight weeks after fertilization), this stage is complete and your baby becomes known as a fetus until he is born.

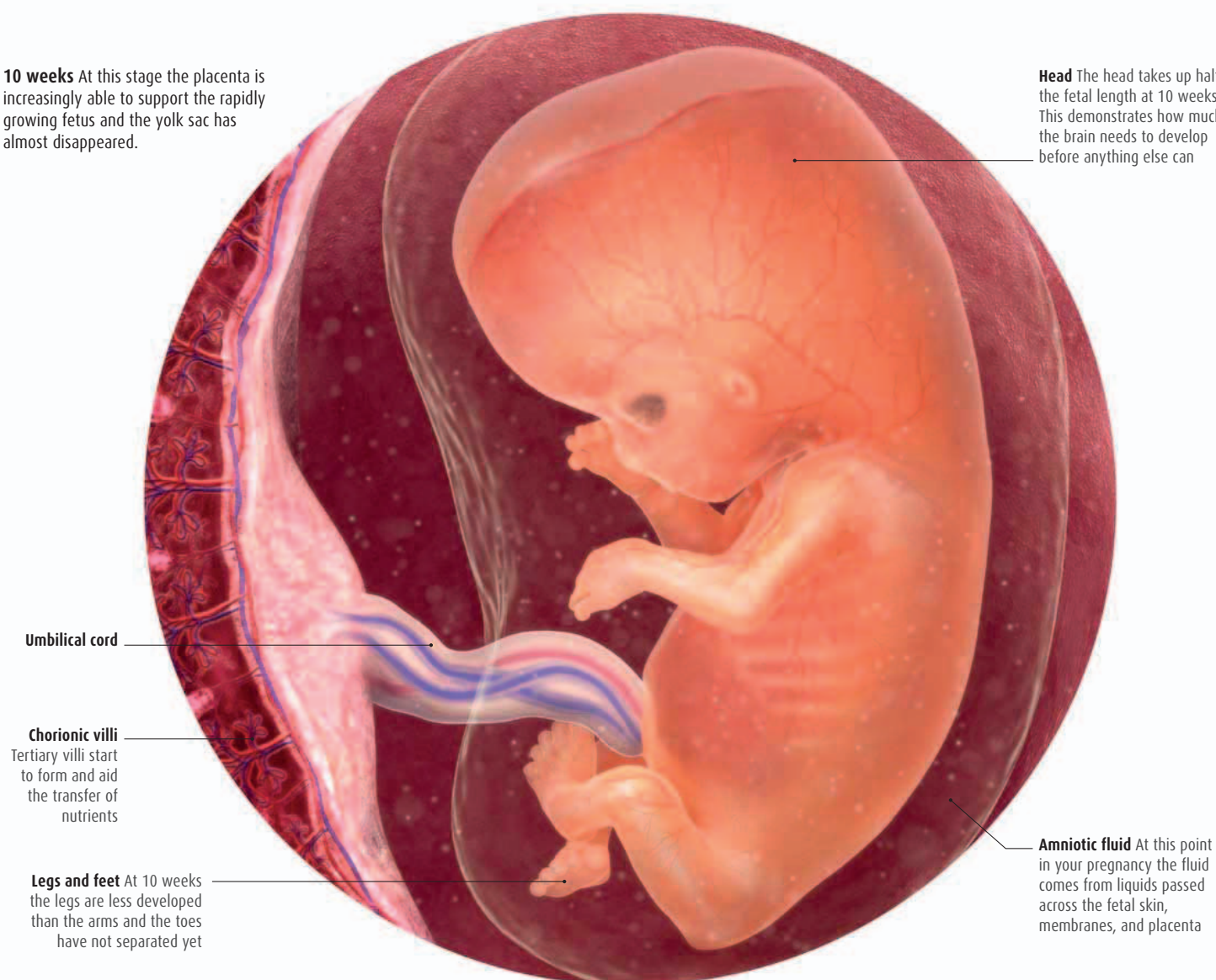
During the embryonic period your baby formed a face, limbs, fingers, and toes, and also rudimentary organs and body systems including the brain, heart, urinary tract, digestive tract, skin, bones, and muscles. By 10 weeks of pregnancy, the basic structures of all the major organs are present but they need further growth and development to gain the complexity of fully functioning systems that will support your baby after birth. The

graduation to fetus status marks the next stage of your baby's development. The body and organs grow rapidly; by contrast, the growth of the head slows down relative to the rest of your baby's body. The shape of the head becomes more recognizably human, and the brain and nervous system link up. By the end of your second trimester your baby will double in weight and have emerging toenails and fingernails, the genitalia will be visible on an

ultrasound, and you'll feel him move—he may even be very active. During the third trimester, fine-tuning takes place in your baby's brain and body systems. He will be able to see and hear in utero, and taste the amniotic fluid. His body will fill out with fat deposits under the skin to keep him insulated after birth. Finally, your baby's lungs are completed, having formed millions of air sacs that will allow him to take his first breath in the outside world.

10 weeks At this stage the placenta is increasingly able to support the rapidly growing fetus and the yolk sac has almost disappeared.

Head The head takes up half the fetal length at 10 weeks. This demonstrates how much the brain needs to develop before anything else can



Umbilical cord

Chorionic villi
Tertiary villi start to form and aid the transfer of nutrients

Legs and feet At 10 weeks the legs are less developed than the arms and the toes have not separated yet

Amniotic fluid At this point in your pregnancy the fluid comes from liquids passed across the fetal skin, membranes, and placenta